



Photo: NRC/ Merti Mekonnen

Abraham Girum (18), Yirgalem Yemane (35) and Robel Abraham (21) were among the 2016 YEP learners who completed courses in Shire, Ethiopia. "We are proud and happy to have completed the training. Today, we have graduated with distinction," said Yirgalem.

ETHIOPIA | Assisting displaced people affected by severe drought

Ethiopia remained one of Africa's leading refugee hosting countries in 2016, with more than 800,000 refugees seeking safety from armed conflicts and relief from droughts.

The Ethiopian Government maintained the policy requiring refugees to reside in refugee camps. However, the government allowed certain refugees to reside in urban areas, primarily Addis Ababa. NRC's Ethiopia programme assisted refugees in Assosa, Dollo Ado, Gambella, Jigjiga and Shire and launched a project for urban refugees in Addis Ababa.

Food security and livelihoods

In 2016, NRC supported income-generating activities, small-scale farming, livestock health, destocking, provision of grain milling equipment and creation of temporary employment through cash-for-work. Cereal production, poultry keeping, bakery businesses, vegetable production and bee-keeping projects enabled more than 5,000 people to enhance their daily income.

Through setting up cooperatives and training people in business management, targeted communities engaged in profitable business ventures. A destocking initiative through slaughter of livestock helped to cushion vulnerable households in Ethiopia's Somali region.

Water, sanitation and hygiene

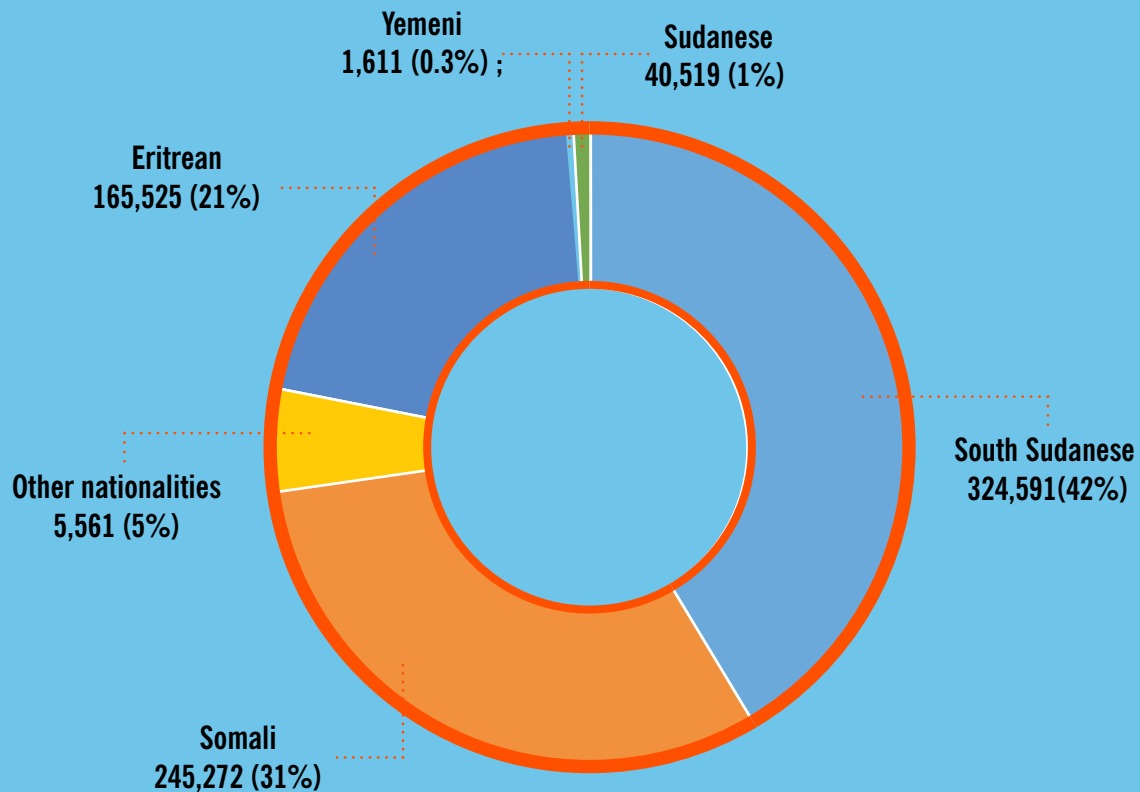
Communities benefitted from drilling and rehabilitating boreholes, and constructing wells. NRC constructed latrines for communities and disseminated information through mass sensitisation and hygiene campaigns. Water, sanitation and hygiene activities succeeded in improving access to clean water and improving the public health status of host communities, internally displaced families and refugees in Dollo Ado and Jigjiga.

Education

The accelerated learning programme in Assosa, Gambella and Shire helped to enhance child protection, and integrate them into formal primary education at an appropriate age and grade level. There was an increase in access to primary education for out-of-school children. Most of them had missed schooling, mainly due to armed conflict in their home countries.

The vocational training programme known as Youth Education Pack (YEP) produced graduates from Assosa, Dollo Ado and Shire who benefitted from business training and market support. The trainees received start-up kits that helped them set up businesses and build their client bases.

REFUGEES IN ETHIOPIA BY NATIONALITY



Data (UNHCR)

Capacity building extended to members of school management, trainers and caregivers who acquired training upgrades on pedagogy and participatory teaching methods, child-friendly teaching and school governance.

Shelter

NRC responded to the influx of new refugees in Gambella by constructing transitional shelters in camps in Jewi, Kule, Pugnido and Tierkidi. Whenever large groups of refugees arrived, the critical need for shelter demanded that the type of shelter selected by NRC be able to deploy immediately and withstand harsh environmental conditions. Transitional shelter included family tents, convertible 'bajaj' shelters and temporary reception centres.

NRC constructed two classroom blocks, an administration block, an ICT laboratory centre and three latrine blocks in Shire. Shelter constructions in Gambella, Addis Ababa, Assosa and Shire contributed in ensuring the physical safety of the refugees.

Child protection

The child protection project was a unique initiative by NRC in Ethiopia that prevented and responded to child abuse, exploitation, neglect and other risks faced by unaccompanied, separated and vulnerable children in refugee camps. In 2016, the project in Adiharush, Mai Aini and Hitsats refugee camps in the Tigray region provided children with a protective upbringing. More than 1,000 children were reunited with their families under the project. Their families received cash assistance and parenting training.

A CASTLE INSIDE A REFUGEE CAMP



Photo:

Refugees in Sherkole, in the Benishangul-Gumuz region of Ethiopia, live in shelters predominantly built by NRC and other humanitarian agencies. However, Repan, a young refugee has chosen to build his own shelter.

Repan Sadik, a 27 year-old father of six children built an impressive three-storey 'castle' in the Sherkole refugee camp. Repan built his housing using bamboo, eucalyptus poles, mud, energy and self-confidence.

"People are always amazed by how I designed the house and how it stays grounded. It is quite a surprise, as thoughts and ideas come to mind unexpectedly, mostly while I'm sleeping," said Repan. "I buy the bamboo and eucalyptus with money put aside from selling furniture. I used to build the house during the night time and in the day time I would make and sell furniture," Repan explained.

The large house is not yet complete, so Repan is working hard to acquire the remaining materials. Meanwhile, his family started living on the ground floor. For a person who relied on humanitarian aid and handouts, building a big house was not an easy task. However, Repan was up to the challenge.

"I need to do more work inside and outside, so that my family can make use of every room."

Repan developed confidence over the years, thanks to architectural and engineering skills, acquired from his father before they separated back in 2011. He has also benefitted from shelter maintenance training provided by NRC in Sherkole.

Repan is a hardworking Sudanese with many skills. He offers his services to humanitarian agencies in Sherkole, as a casual worker. He has also benefited from the seed distributions through the NRC livelihood project.

Repan received cabbage and black pepper seeds, that he was able to plant, harvest and sell for the benefit of his household. He is currently preparing his garden to plant the seeds he acquired, as the rainy season is coming up.

"Finding a strong and colourful house resembling a castle inside a refugee camp is like finding an oasis in the desert. It is creative; it is simple and has a lot of space for every purpose. Refugees can teach us many things. They have many ideas that can transform our societies," says Emebet Abdissa, NRC's Programme Officer in Ethiopia.

Sherkole is home to over 11,000 refugees from Sudan and DR Congo. NRC has assisted refugees in the Benishangul Gumuz region in Ethiopia since 2012.